

FieldFlow

Content Style Guide

FieldFlow Content Style Guide

The single source of truth for **what words to use**, **how to say things**, and **how to format them** across the FieldFlow platform — the dashboard, the WhatsApp messages, the AI-generated reports, the emails, the documentation.

If two pieces of content disagree, this guide wins.

Maintained by Product. Reviewed quarterly. Last updated: June 2026 · v1.0

1. Voice & tone

FieldFlow is the calm, capable colleague at the back of the room who knows where every file is. We are:

- **Respectful** — every user, from board chair to first-day field worker, gets the same dignity in language.
- **Plain** — short words, short sentences. Read at class-8 level.
- **Specific** — numbers in context, not adjectives ("12 trainings completed" not "great progress").
- **Honest** — say what we know, say what we don't. Never overpromise.
- **Hopeful** — we believe in our users' work. Our tone reflects that, never cynical.

What we are **not**:

- Cute or playful in serious moments (incident reports, errors)
- Salesy or hype-y ("Game-changing," "Revolutionary," "Best-in-class")
- Patronising ("Don't worry, we'll handle the hard stuff for you")
- Bureaucratic ("As per the aforementioned policy")
- Tech-jargony in user-facing surfaces ("Webhook signature validation failed")

Quick voice test

Read your text out loud. If you wouldn't say it that way to a colleague over chai, rewrite it.

2. The canonical term list

These are the **only** terms used in the product, docs, and AI output for these concepts.

Concept	Canonical term	Don't use
The people we serve	beneficiaries (formal) / community members (warm)	participants, recipients, users, end-users, targets

Concept	Canonical term	Don't use
A person reachable via WhatsApp	contact	lead, user, subscriber
A tagged group of contacts	collection	list, audience, segment, group
The household-level data unit	household	family, HH, dwelling
Field staff who collect data	field worker (general) / field officer (mid-level) / programme manager (senior)	staff (alone), employee, agent, surveyor
The annual delivery matrix	action plan	workplan, project plan, MEAL plan
A row in the action plan	activity	task, intervention, line item
An outcome we measure	indicator	KPI, metric, measure
What was delivered	output	deliverable, achievement
What changed as a result	outcome	impact (reserve for the highest level), benefit
Long-term societal change	impact	difference, effect
A discrete field event	report (one) / field report (if disambiguation needed)	submission, entry, log, observation
An AI-generated narrative	generated report / draft	output, result
A WhatsApp conversation script	flow	bot, chatbot, dialogue, journey
A one-time WA mass message	broadcast	blast, campaign, push
The FieldFlow platform itself	FieldFlow (one word, capital F, capital F)	Field Flow, fieldflow, FF
The platform's AI brain	the assistant	the AI, the bot, FieldFlow AI
The login	sign in (verb) / sign-in (noun)	log in, login (verb)
The logout	sign out	log out, logout (verb)
An organisation on the platform	organisation (UK spelling — we serve India)	org (long form), tenant, account
A user's role	role	permission, level, tier
Funder of an NGO	donor	funder (acceptable in formal), sponsor, partner
The action plan accountability holder	responsibility holder / owner	assignee, person-in-charge

Capitalisation: product feature names are Title Case in headings (Action Plan, Quick Report) and lowercase in running prose ("upload an action plan"). Tab labels are sentence case ("Action plan").

3. Numbers & dates

Item	Style
Currency	■ 1,234 (no decimal for whole rupees). For large: ■ 1.2 crore / ■ 45 lakh — never ■1,20,00,000 in user-facing text
Date (formal)	18 June 2026 (DD Month YYYY — never US "June 18, 2026")
Date (compact / table)	18 Jun 2026
Date in WhatsApp	18 June (drop year unless ambiguous)
Time	3:30pm (lowercase am/pm, no period)

Item	Style
Date range	18–25 June 2026 (en-dash, no spaces)
Quantities	Spell out one through nine , numerals for 10+ . Exception: tables always use numerals.
Percentages	67% (no space). For specific decimals: 67.3% (one decimal).
Large numbers	1,200 (comma) below 1 lakh. 1.2 lakh / 1.2 crore beyond.
Indicator targets	240 of 1,200 (not "240/1200")
Phone numbers	+91 98765 43210 (with spaces). In WhatsApp logs, mask to +91 * 3210 .
Mobile-only phone (Indian)	9876543210 (no country code, no spaces) — for inline forms

4. Grammar & punctuation

- **Oxford comma:** yes. "Khagaria, Saharsa, and Madhubani."
- **Spelling:** UK English. "organise, recognise, behaviour, colour, programme." Exception: "program" when referring to software programs.
- **Quotes:** double "quotes" for speech, single 'quotes' inside.
- **Em-dashes:** use with NO spaces — like this. (Some teams use spaces; we don't.)
- **En-dashes:** for ranges (18–25), not hyphens.
- **Hyphens:** "field-officer training" (compound adjective before a noun). "training of field officers" (no hyphen).
- **Apostrophes:** "the worker's report" (singular possessive). "the workers' reports" (plural possessive).
- **Sentence length:** target ≤ 20 words. If you wrote 30, split it.
- **One thought per sentence.** If you used "and" or "however" mid-sentence, consider a full stop.

5. Buttons, labels, microcopy

Button copy

Use **verbs in imperative form**. The button says what the user is about to do, not what the system will do.

■ Use	■ Don't use
Save changes	Save / OK
Send report	Submit / Confirm
Generate report	Run / Process
Sign in	Login
Add team member	Create user

■ Use	■ Don't use
Upload action plan	Choose file
Cancel	Close / Dismiss
Discard draft	No (in a dialog)

Confirmation dialogs

Format: **{action verb} {object}?** in the title. Body explains consequence. Buttons are **{verb}** and **Cancel**.

Title: Delete Khagaria action plan?
 Body: This will move the plan to archive. You can restore it from
 Manage → Archived plans within 30 days.
 Buttons: [Archive plan] [Cancel]

Tooltips

Maximum **two sentences**. First sentence = what this is. Second sentence (optional) = how to use it.

■ "Annual target — the total quantity this activity aims to achieve in the financial year. Updated only by admins."

■ "Annual Target"

Form labels

Sentence case. No colons. Use full words, not abbreviations.

■ "Phone number"

■ "Phone Number:" or "Phone No."

Placeholders

Show **format**, not example data.

■ "10 digits, no country code"

■ "9876543210" (looks like a real number — confusing)

Validation messages

Tell the user **what to do**, not what they did wrong.

■ "Phone number needs 10 digits without country code."

■ "Invalid phone number format."

6. WhatsApp-specific style

WhatsApp is the most-read channel. Every word matters.

- **Greeting:** "Namaste ■" (default Hindi-speaking regions). "Hello ■" (default English). "Pranam" (formal, older audience). Never "Hi" or "Hey."
- **Sign-off:** "Thank you ■" or "Reply if you need anything else." Never "Have a great day!" or "Cheers."
- **Length:** under 200 characters for routine messages. Under 600 for instructional. Anything longer becomes a list with bullets.
- **Emojis:** sparingly, for warmth and visual anchor. One at start, maybe one at end. Never decorative-only.
- **Personalisation:** use `{{contact.name}}` `ji` for Hindi-region contacts. Use `{{contact.name}}` (no honorific) for English-speakers.
- **Calls to action:** ONE per message. "Reply YES to confirm" — not three things to do.
- **Avoid jargon:** "registered" → "added you to our list." "submission" → "what you sent."

7. AI-generated content style

When the AI drafts (reports, emails, replies), it MUST:

- **Lead with a number.** "47 women joined the SHG in June..." (not "We saw an increase in SHG membership in June...")
- **Use past tense for completed work.** Never present continuous ("we are conducting...").
- **Cite sources.** Every figure must trace back to a `daily_report` or `DB` field. Use `■MISSING■` when data is absent (defined below).
- **Refuse to fabricate.** If asked to "make the numbers look better," reply: "I can show the actual numbers in different framings, but I can't change what was reported. Let me show three honest framings."
- **No filler phrases.** No "It is important to note that..." / "In this report we will discuss..." / "As you can see from the data..."
- **Cite people by role, not name** in donor-facing reports. "A field officer in Khagaria reported..." not "Priya Kumari reported..." — unless the named individual gave explicit consent for attribution.

The MISSING marker

When data is absent, use this **exact format**:

`■MISSING: <one-line description of what is needed>■`

Examples:

- `■MISSING: gender disaggregation for May training■`
- `■MISSING: photographs from Saharsa visit■`

This forces a human edit pass before sending to a donor. Do NOT pad or guess.

8. Empty states

Every empty state has three parts:

1. **Title** — one short sentence describing the current state ("No reports yet").
2. **Body** — one or two sentences explaining what populates this list and why it's empty.
3. **Action** — one clear next step ("Generate your first report") OR no action if the user is just supposed to wait.



> No reports yet

> Your team can submit reports right from WhatsApp — no app to download. Share your WhatsApp business number and watch reports appear here.

> [See how it works]



> No data available.

9. Error messages

Every error has three parts:

1. **What happened** — in plain words. "Couldn't reach the server."
2. **What to try** — one concrete next action. "Check your connection and try again."
3. **What if that fails** — reference ID or support contact.

Never show:

- HTTP status codes ("Error 500")
- Stack traces or technical jargon
- Generic "Something went wrong" without context
- Blame-shifting ("Bad request" — bad request from whom?)

See `src/i18n/errorCopy.ts` for the canonical error message library.

10. Inclusive language

- **Gender:** "they/them" as singular when gender is unknown. "Field worker," "field officer" (not "fieldman"). Avoid "manpower" → use "team" / "people."
 - **Caste:** never reference caste publicly. Use "social category" in forms (SC/ST/OBC/General) only when statutorily required.
 - **Disability:** "person with a disability" (person-first). Never "disabled person," "differently-abled," or "specially-abled."
 - **Age:** "older adults" (not "elderly," "senior citizens" unless they self-identify).
 - **Religion:** never assume. "Festival" is preferable to specific festival names unless contextually relevant.
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11. Localisation principles

- **Hindi UI** is shipped as primary regional language. Marathi, Bengali, Tamil, Telugu, Odia follow.
- **WhatsApp messages** auto-detect language from the contact's first message, with manual override per contact.
- **Reports** generate in the language the user chose, but field-quote attributions keep the original language inline + translation in parentheses.

When translating:

- **Do not transliterate brand names.** "FieldFlow" stays as "FieldFlow" in Devanagari rendering.
 - **Numbers stay in Western Arabic digits** (1, 2, 3) even in Hindi text, unless the org explicitly opts for Devanagari numerals.
 - **Cultural specificity beats literal translation.** "Beneficiary" → "■■■■■■■■■■" feels bureaucratic; for warm channels prefer "■■■■■" or context-specific words like "■■■■■" / "■■■■■■ ■■■■."
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12. Document headers (in the platform)

Every report / generated doc must have:

- **Title** — clear, no marketing fluff.
 - **Period covered** — date range.
 - **Generated by** — user name + timestamp.
 - **Source disclosure** — "Based on 247 field reports between 1 April and 30 June 2026. Some figures pending verification."
 - **Footer** — "Generated by FieldFlow · <date> · cid: <id>"
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13. Things we explicitly DON'T do

- **No exclamation marks** outside genuine celebration (a worker hitting a milestone). Never in error messages, never in transactional confirmations.
- **No ALL CAPS** for emphasis. Bold or italics instead.
- **No "Click here"** links. The link text describes what the link goes to.
- **No "the user"** in user-facing copy. Address them as "you."
- **No "etc."** — finish the list or stop the list. "And more" if truly open-ended.
- **No "obviously," "simply," "just,"** — minimising words that shame the reader.
- **No emoji in headlines** of formal reports. Allowed in WhatsApp + dashboard cards.
- **No referring to AI as "magical"** — it's a tool, not magic.

14. Approval workflow for new copy

1. Anyone can draft copy.
2. Copy that ships externally (donor reports, public-facing communications, marketing) needs a second human reviewer.
3. AI-generated copy that goes external needs a designated human approver per the org's settings.
4. Microcopy changes (buttons, error messages) need product owner review before deploy.

15. Style guide changelog

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	2026-06-18	Initial. Established canonical term list, voice rules, WhatsApp style, AI output rules.

Style is the substance. Read the doc, apply the rules, push back when something feels wrong — this guide changes through use.